RE- DEFINING HIGHER EDUCATION: ENABLING YOUTH LEADERSHIP FOR A BETTER TOMORROW



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Executive President of MITWPU, Rahul Vishwanath Karad, is an enterprising educationist at the forefront of the 72-institute, 55,000-student strong MAEER'S MIT Group of Institutions, Pune. A graduate in engineering, a postgraduate in management from Cardiff UK, and an alumnus of the Harvard Business School, USA, Karad is committed to channelizing the power of youth to lead India by providing them with a holistic and value-based education. It is this commitment of Karad which resulted in the founding of the MIT School of Government, the first institute of its kind in Asia, which has been devoted to strengthening the fabric of Indian democratic leadership.

Q Under your leadership, MITWPU has become a forerunner in nation building. Your focus has been on women empowerment, rural-governance, and building a responsible leadership with spiritual approach. Can you throw more light on this unique approach?

In this digital age, the pace of technological and scientific progress is almost exponential. So, it becomes imperative to match the pace of progress with the pace of nation-building. This is because they are synergistically connected to each other.

Moreover, considering that India is the world's largest democracy and a contender to become a global superpower, it becomes essential to enhance the quality of our democracy. This can only happen through efficient and honest governance which is representative of not just young faces but all sections of society. This approach can only be successful as long as the leadership overseeing these facets has been tempered by spiritual thought which serves to enhance their reasoning ability along with inculcating within them a firm ethical and moral core. For this reason, I started the Bharatiya Chhatra Sansad to connect the politically and socially active youth of India on one common platform.

Additionally, the National Women's Parliament, a platform for women from diverse backgrounds, was created for women to come together and share their experiences, share knowledge and research in the area of women's social economic and political empowerment. We also have numerous other social initiatives aimed at simultaneously improving the quality of journalism by imbuing transparency through our National Conference on Media and Journalism, of improving pedagogy through our National Teachers' Congress, and many such others.

The purpose of all our social initiatives is to make direct impact on the society so that we are able to create a positive cycle where an improvement in one field leads to an improvement in another, and finally, the cumulative effects of these improvements lead to us strengthening our democracy.

Q In your leadership spanning so many years, what would you consider some of your milestone achievements?

It is difficult to answer this question since there are so many milestones that we, as an institution, keep achieving, and I happen to be proud of each and every one of them! However, apart from achieving the highest academic excellence through the conventional